

Sound Design & Musical Direction Brief

Remediation Atelier Media Design 2

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Mid check in: 3rd of August - send your work in progress to Douglas and to each three group
Final Deadline : 31st of August - no delay. Send your sound file and sound concept to Douglas
Edric Stanley

To complete your ECTS credits, your task is to develop a sound design proposal for each student project (3 projects in total):

- Dear Friend
- Thé ou Café
- Oops

Here is the link to consult the Projects documentation:

<https://drive.switch.ch/index.php/s/NOuZL0E4rczliCN>

Step 1 — Read the Press Kits

Please begin by reading the press kit for every group.

These documents explain each project's concept, goals, and intended experience.

Reach out to the three group to make sure you are on the same wave length when it comes to the sound part.

Step 2 — Develop a Sound Identity

For each project, propose a minimalist sound direction that supports its narrative and interaction.

The goal is **not** to compose background music. Instead, think of sound as part of the storytelling and interaction design.

References

Good references

- **Everything** — an excellent example of interaction-driven musical sound design. User interactions themselves become musical, often using only a few carefully chosen notes. ([Link example](#))
- **Proteus** — another strong example of minimalist musical interaction. It is more musical than we should aim for in this exhibition, but it is still a valuable reference. ([Link example](#))

Reference to avoid imitating directly

- **Florence** — while beautifully composed, it relies on continuous musical accompaniment. This approach is not suitable for our exhibition context. ([Link example](#))

Exhibition Constraints

The exhibition space is shared by many projects.

- Avoid continuous music or looping ambient tracks.
- Do not include music on waiting or idle screens.
- Sound should appear only when the visitor is actively interacting with the experience.
- Subtle environmental ambience is acceptable when it is unobtrusive (for example, light rain outside the café), provided it does not dominate the exhibition space.

If a project constantly emits music, exhibition staff will likely mute it for the entire event.

Design Philosophy

Rather than creating realistic soundscapes, aim to give each project a distinctive narrative identity through sound.

Whenever appropriate:

- replace conventional sound effects with musical sound effects;
- use short musical gestures, motifs, or even a single note to reinforce important emotional or interactive moments;
- let interactions feel expressive rather than purely realistic.

For example, instead of relying only on realistic café ambience, the background rumble could become a stylised musical texture that supports the project's emotional tone.

The objective is to create sound that feels intentional, memorable, and emotionally meaningful while remaining discreet within the exhibition environment.